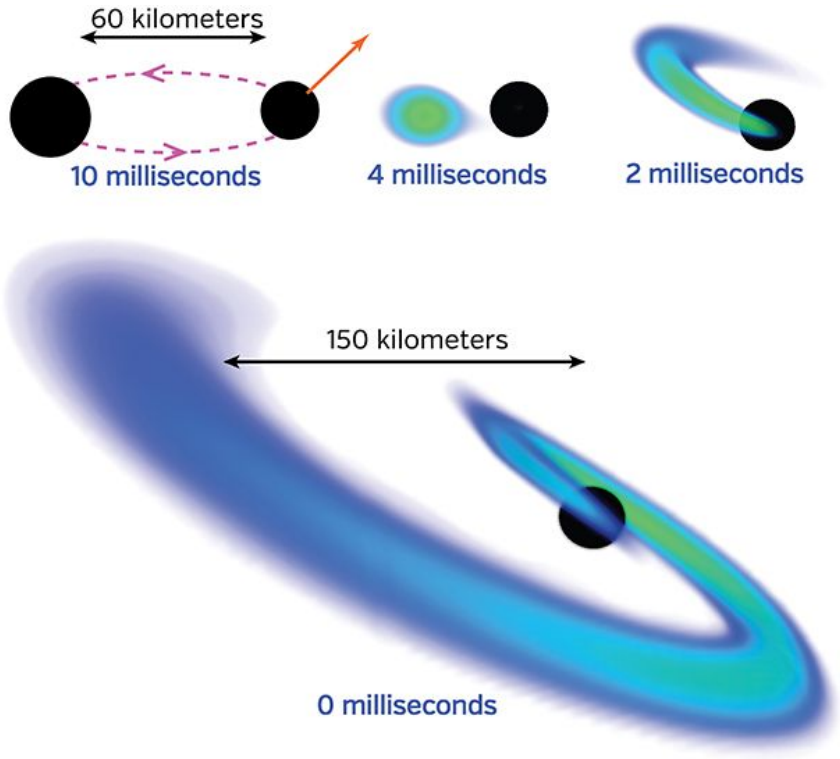


Fig. 16.4. Computer simulation of the last few milliseconds of the neutron star's life. *[From a simulation by Francois Foucart, and colleagues. See http://www.black-holes.org/.]*

Discovering the Wormhole

Looking back through LIGO's data for the preceding two years, Professor Brand and his team discovered very weak waves emitted by the neutron star. The star had a tiny mountain, a centimeter high and a few kilometers wide (such mountains are thought likely). As the mountain was carried around and around by the star's rotation, it produced waves that oscillated weakly but steadily, day after day after day.

By analyzing these steady waves with care, Professor Brand learned the direction to their source. The direction was unbelievable! The waves were coming from something in orbit around Saturn. As the Earth and Saturn moved in their orbits, the source was always near Saturn!